

small apartment, moved in the furniture, and planned their next trip. He still wanted to start a new business venture, but he had no idea what it was. He decided to enjoy himself until he found out.

DON'T WORK FOR YOUR ASSETS

The \$50-a-Day Rule says the money we spend on *us* is only \$50 a day. That's \$18,000 a year. But you're spending more than \$18,000 a year, aren't you? A hell of a lot more. Off the top come income taxes or some of those tax shelters that seem to cost more than the taxes. With what you have left you pay the mortgage. You pay condo expenses, property insurance, and property taxes. You make car payments and car insurance payments. You have car repair bills, gas bills, oil and lube bills, parking fees, and parking tickets. That's on two cars plus a recreational vehicle or two. Then there are all those toys: cameras, home stereo and video equipment, expensive but rarely used ski and camping equipment, computers, motorcycles, and his and hers swimming pools. In short, after paying to keep the world safe for democracy—paying the retroactive tribute for the privilege of having the freedom to make all that money—your income goes to maintain your assets.

I know. I was once in the same place. Instead of my assets working for me, I was working for them. I call that the money I spend on *them* rather than the \$50 a day on *us*. And I ask myself, how in the hell did I get into this mess?

How many others are trapped like I was and want to get out?

In chapter 4 I offer detailed advice on how to convert your net worth into assets that work for you—so you can stop working for them. It tells how to avoid slow death from the two great killers: the big house and the fast car. Hard assets create expenses. When you retire, you want your equity in liquid assets that can sweat for *you*. You'll find you need to